

BANKING-AS-A-SERVICE • UK MARKET ENTRY

Digital Bank Launch Strategy

Request for Proposal: BaaS Vendor Evaluation & Go-to-Market Strategy

Client: Client X (anonymized), U.S.-headquartered bank

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Context: Academic consulting engagement, Synpulse Consulting × Strathclyde Business School

The Challenge

Why Client X needed an RFP-led approach

Client X is a multi-billion-dollar bank headquartered in the United States, with a substantial existing market capitalization and a well-established domestic customer base.

As part of its international growth strategy, Client X wanted to launch a digital retail banking proposition in the United Kingdom — a market it did not yet operate in.

Entering the UK required two connected decisions, made under one engagement.

1

Platform decision

Which Banking-as-a-Service (BaaS) platform to build the new digital bank on.

2

Positioning decision

How to design and position a competitive digital product in an already crowded UK market.

Engagement scope

BaaS vendor RFP + evaluation, and a go-to-market strategy for UK launch.

Engagement Scope & Objectives

1

Vendor RFP & evaluation

Run a formal RFP process across BaaS providers and score them against a structured, weighted framework.

2

Digital product design

Define the feature set and customer experience for the new UK digital bank.

3

Go-to-market strategy

Build a segmentation, product roadmap, and channel plan for a competitive UK launch.

4

Regulatory alignment

Ensure platform and channel choices are consistent with UK banking regulation.

Methodology

Two frameworks, run in parallel

Multi-Criteria Decision Analysis (MCDA)

Structured vendor evaluation using weighted scoring across defined dimensions.

- 1 Define evaluation criteria
- 2 Score each vendor per criterion
- 3 Apply category weights
- 4 Rank & shortlist vendors

Go-to-Market Framework

Three elements aligned to UK banking regulation.

- 1 Customer segmentation strategy
- 2 Product roadmap development
- 3 Digital channel strategy

RFP · Background & Scope of Work

Excerpt — as issued to prospective BaaS providers

1. Issuing organization

Client X, a U.S.-headquartered retail bank, on behalf of its planned UK digital banking subsidiary.

2. Purpose of this RFP

To identify and select a Banking-as-a-Service platform partner capable of supporting a new UK retail digital bank, from initial launch through scale.

3. Scope of work requested from respondents

- Core banking and ledger infrastructure, hosted or API-delivered
- Card issuing, payments, and settlement capability for the UK market
- Compliance support for UK regulatory requirements
- Roadmap for embedded finance and product extensibility

4. Anonymization note

Client and vendor names withheld; evaluation categories and process reflect the methodology used on the engagement.

RFP · Vendor Evaluation Criteria

Weighted scoring applied under the MCDA framework

8

BaaS vendors
evaluated

Scored against four weighted
categories below



Technology architecture

API design, integration effort, core banking flexibility.



Scalability

Ability to support growth in customers and transaction volume.



Regulatory compliance

Fit with UK banking and data regulation requirements.



Cost structure

Licensing, transaction, and implementation cost model.

RFP · Target Market & Product Requirements

What the platform needs to support

Target customer

**Urban professionals,
ages 25–45**

United Kingdom

Identified as an underserved segment within an already crowded UK digital banking market — the basis for product differentiation rather than head-on competition.

1

AI-driven budgeting tools

Personalized insights and spend management built on platform data.

2

Embedded finance features

Third-party financial products surfaced natively in the app.

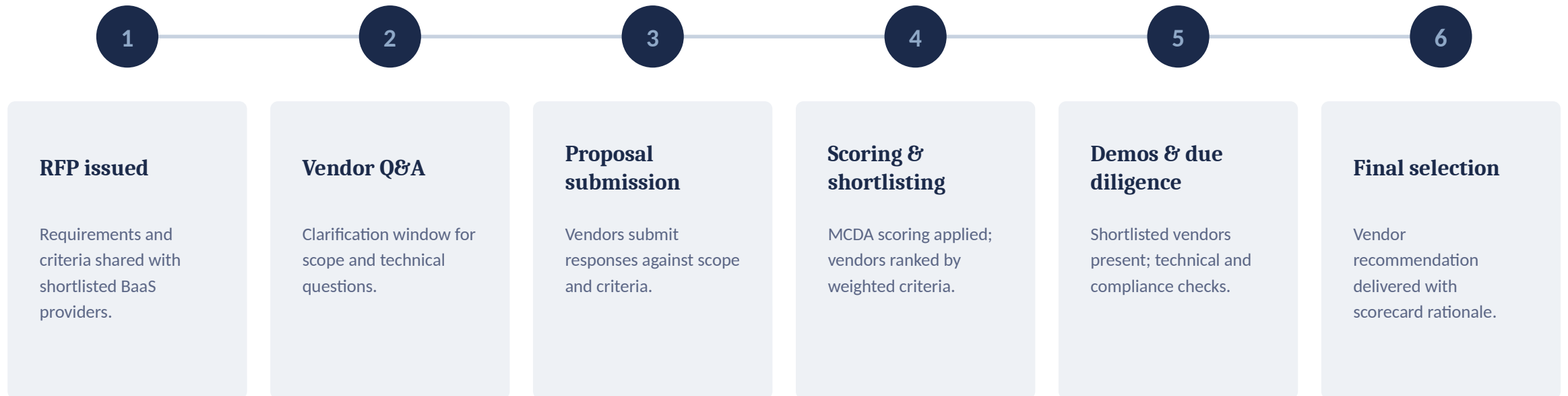
3

Sustainable banking options

ESG-aligned account and investment features.

RFP · Submission Process & Timeline

Indicative phasing — standard RFP process structure



Evaluation Outcome & Roadmap

Vendor selection approach

A vendor scorecard balanced immediate operational needs against future roadmap alignment — not lowest cost alone.

Market differentiation

Underserved customer segments were pinpointed and targeted product features designed against specific pain points, rather than competing head-on with incumbents.

Go-to-market roadmap

- 1 Vendor onboarding & platform build
- 2 Phased customer acquisition, target segment first
- 3 Feature rollout: budgeting, embedded finance, sustainable banking
- 4 Scale across broader UK segments

Deliverables

1

Vendor evaluation framework

MCDA scoring model across 8 BaaS vendors, with weighted criteria and final recommendation.

2

Phased go-to-market roadmap

Customer acquisition strategy, product roadmap, and channel plan for UK launch.

About this project

This deck simplifies and restates a case study completed as an academic consulting project with Synpulse Consulting at Strathclyde Business School. Client and vendor names are anonymized; the RFP structure, evaluation criteria, and go-to-market framework reflect the methodology used on the engagement.